

Southpeak Outdoor Brand Strategy

Brand refresh - from trailhead to everyday

Prepared by the Southpeak Brand Council

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Confidential - internal use only

Fictional data created for the MarketSignal demo.

1. Executive summary

Southpeak Outdoor is a Boulder based maker of hiking boots, trail runners, shell jackets and packs. We expect net revenue of \$284.0 million for FY26 on a latest estimate basis, with growth led by our own digital channels and by the Ridgeline shell jacket. This document sets out how we intend to refresh the brand over the next three years and what our customers have told us we must fix first.

Our research points to a brand that customers like and trust on the trail but find inconsistent off it. Boots, trail runners and packs are each well regarded individually, yet the way they fit, wear and arrive does not feel like the work of one company. The refresh therefore concentrates on consistency before novelty: one fit language across product lines, clearer information on how long gear should last and what it is made from, a faster and more dependable delivery promise, and a loyalty program that rewards people for time outdoors.

- Fit consistency across boots, trail runners and shells is the largest source of customer frustration in our 2026 survey.
- Durability and repair, plus plain information about materials, are the most credible levers for sustainability trust.
- Delivery speed is a growing expectation, especially among Urban Outdoor and Family Campers shopping online.
- Personalized patches are a low cost way to deepen the Basecamp Rewards relationship and test appetite for personalization.
- Community, from stewardship days to outfitter partners, is the engine of word of mouth and should be funded as such.

2. Who we serve

We serve four customer segments, which differ in how often they get outdoors, what they spend, and which channels they use. The shares below are of our active customer file.

Segment | Share of customers | Typical purchase

Weekend Hikers | 38% | Day hiking boots and trail runners

Alpine Committed | 17% | Shells, technical boots, packs

Urban Outdoor | 24% | Light shells, commuter packs

Family Campers | 21% | Packs, multi item bundles

Weekend Hikers are the core of the franchise. They buy one or two pairs of footwear a year, read reviews carefully and are the group most affected by uncertainty about size. Alpine Committed customers are fewer but spend the most per order and will notice any flaw in materials or seams. Urban Outdoor customers are younger, buy online and expect delivery to match what they get from other online retailers. Family Campers buy for several people at once and are the most sensitive to value and to returns.

Our channels are the brand site, the app, marketplaces, our own stores and a network of outfitter partners. Outfitter partners remain the largest single channel at roughly three tenths of sales, followed by the brand site, marketplaces, stores and the app. The app is the smallest channel but is growing fastest, and its members are the most active in Basecamp Rewards.

3. What customers tell us

In April 2026 we surveyed 300 customers across all four segments and followed up with a series of interviews in June. The survey asked respondents to name their top frustration with Southpeak. The results are summarized below, together with the commentary that came through in the interviews.

3.1 Fit inconsistency

Fit inconsistency between Southpeak hiking boots and trail runners was named by 33% of survey respondents. Customers describe boots that run slightly large and trail runners that run true or a little small, so that a person who is one size in one product ends up in another size in the next. Many mentioned ordering two sizes and returning one. Shells and packs raise a different version of the same problem, with sleeve length and torso length varying between seasons.

Fit also shapes returns and the cost of serving customers, because every wrong size means a second shipment and a delay before the customer gets outside. We believe that a unified fit standard and a clear size guide, backed by an exchange promise, is the single most valuable improvement available to the brand.

3.2 Durability

About 11% of respondents named product durability as their top frustration. Complaints centered on outsole wear in trail runners, zip performance on shells, and stitching at pack stress points. Alpine Committed customers expect to repair gear rather than replace it and ask why we do not make repair easier.

3.3 Sustainability transparency

Some 14% of respondents named sustainability transparency as their top issue, a higher share than we expected. Customers say they want to know the recycled content of a jacket, the country of manufacture and the repair options before they buy. They distrust general claims and warm up to measurable ones. Several interviewees noted that a repair program would convince them more than any label.

3.4 Delivery speed

One in ten respondents named delivery speed as their top frustration, but the proportion rises sharply among Urban Outdoor customers and anyone buying for a trip with a fixed date. Customers who shop through marketplaces compare us with sellers who deliver within two days, and they notice the difference.

3.5 Personalization and community

Only 6% of respondents named a lack of personalization as their top issue, so we treat it as an enhancement rather than a repair. Interviewees who did like the idea talked about patches, embroidered names on packs and trail badges that mark an achievement. Community fared slightly better: 8% named a lack of community or social proof, and many more said that friends and hiking groups were their main source of recommendations.

4. Strategic priorities

4.1 One fit language

We will define a single fit standard across boots, trail runners, shells and packs, publish measurements on every product page, and add a way to compare a new item with one the customer already owns. Product development will adopt the standard from the spring 2027 season, and existing lines will be adjusted at their next revision. The goal is to cut the share of customers naming fit as their top frustration by about a third within two years.

4.2 Build to last, and say so

We will set and publish an expected service life for each major product, expand repair and resole services, and invest in outsole and zip quality. For sustainability, we will place material composition and manufacturing location on every product page and report progress against specific goals once a year, rather than relying on general claims.

4.3 A delivery promise customers can rely on

Delivery is a service we can control. We will redesign fulfillment around two goals: a reliable estimated delivery date at checkout, and a faster option in the metropolitan areas where most of our online customers live. Initial work will focus on a small number of Mountain West markets, and we will expand only after measuring cost and customer response.

4.4 Ridgeline as the brand's flagship

Southpeak Outdoor wants its Ridgeline shell jacket to reach \$52 million in sales by FY28. The Ridgeline is the product that best represents what we want the brand to be: lightweight, repairable and consistent in fit. It will carry the first visible expression of the refresh, including a new size guide, a published service life and a lifetime repair offer.

4.5 Personalized patches

A modest personalization test will let Basecamp Rewards members add a patch to a pack or jacket, using designs that mark trail milestones. We view this as a low cost way of reinforcing identity and loyalty, and we will measure it on repeat purchase and on delivery time. If patches add noticeable wait, we will provide them as a separate item rather than delay the main order.

4.6 Community

We will increase support for stewardship days, guided outings with outfitter partners and member led hiking groups. Success will be measured by participation, by the number of members who invite a friend, and by the proportion of new customers who cite a personal recommendation.

5. Risks and next steps

The main risks are execution capacity and cost. A unified fit standard touches every product team, and changes to fulfillment may add expense in the near term. Some customers may also perceive the refresh as a change of identity; we will test messaging with a sample of each segment before launch.

Sustainability disclosures must be accurate and reviewed by legal and product teams to avoid overstating claims.

- Finalize the fit standard and agree the size guide design by the end of the third quarter.
- Publish expected service life and material information for the top ten products before the holiday season.
- Select pilot markets for the faster delivery promise and agree the operating budget.
- Launch the personalized patch test with a limited group of Basecamp Rewards members.
- Report progress to the board each quarter against the survey baseline.

Taken together, these steps are meant to make Southpeak feel like one dependable brand from the first purchase to the tenth. The refresh does not rely on a new logo or a single campaign; it relies on repeated, small proofs that the company keeps its promises.